redistributed after exhuming them from earlier ones.[17] The exaggerated number apart, the Ashokan stamp on stupas in different parts of India is unmistakable. Within this programme of stupa construction and relic redistribution, it is unlikely that a provincial capital like Junagadh would have been bypassed, especially as the edicts were so majestically inscribed. If so, the Bhoria stupa can be the only site where such relics would have been interred in the Junagadh area. The relics that have been found inside the stupa also lend credence to this assumption.

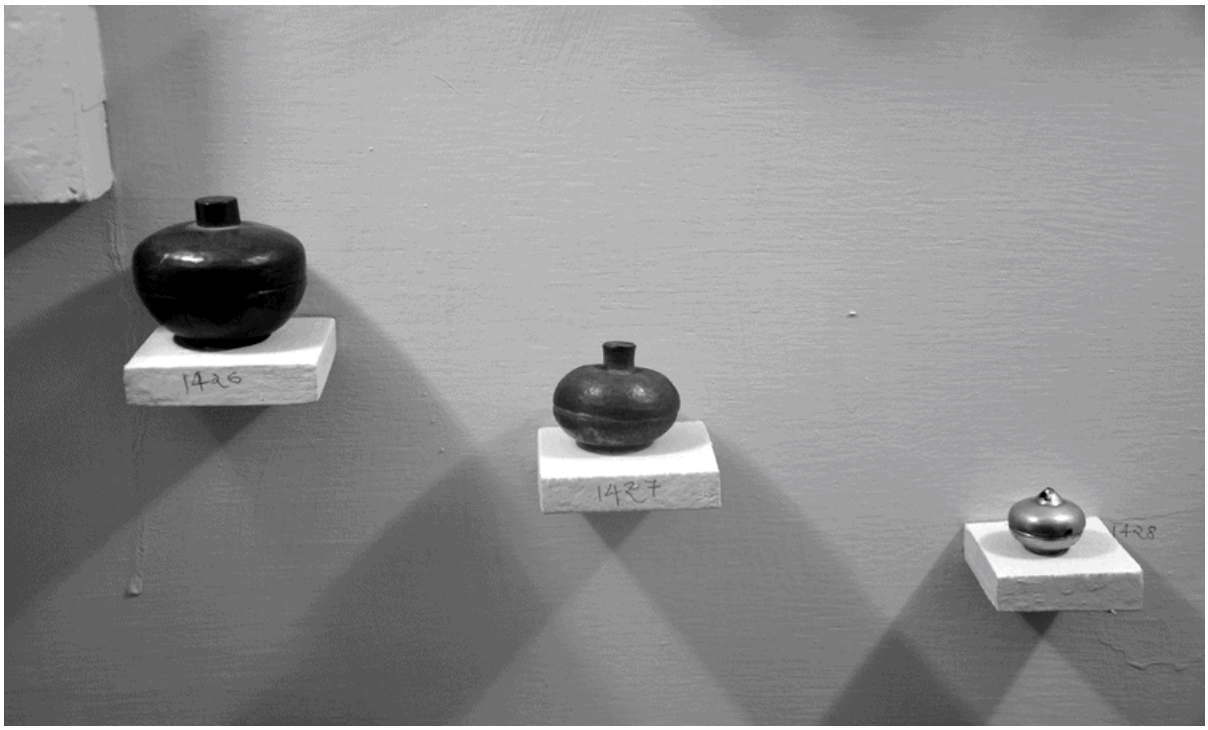


Fig. 9.3: Copies of the copper, silver, and gold relic boxes found inside the Bhoria stupa (now in the Junagadh State Museum)

In and around the hills of Girnar, structural complexes of which remnants survive also used large burnt bricks.[18] Their Mauryan ancestry thus seems likely. At Surajkund in the Girnar sanctuary there was a circular well cut into the natural rock, and another lined with bricks.[19] The bricks are large and of various sizes, some decorated with figure marks, a chaitya, and a conch. In another part of the forest, in the Hasnapur dam area and